HOORVIA — CHICKEN INTERNAL TEMPERATURE CHART (WHITE VS DARK MEAT GUIDE)

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet • 165°F White Meat vs 175°F Dark Meat • Pasteurization Time • US Letter (8.5" × 11")

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■ CHICKEN INTERNAL TEMPERATURES BY CUT (PULL TEMP VS. FINAL RESTED TEMP)

Chicken Cut	Meat Type	Pull From Heat At	Final Rested Temp	Rest Time & Texture Goal
Boneless Skinless Breast	Lean White	158°F–160°F / 70°C	165°F / 74°C	Rest 5 min tented; prevents dry stringiness
Bone-In Split Breast	White + Bone	160°F–162°F / 71°C	165°F / 74°C	Rest 7 min; bone conducts heat into center
Chicken Tenderloins / Strips	Lean White	162°F / 72°C	165°F / 74°C	Rest 3 min; thin cuts have minimal carryover
Boneless Skinless Thighs	Rich Dark	172°F–175°F / 78°C	178°F / 81°C	Rest 5 min; melts tough connective tissue
Bone-In Thighs & Drumsticks	Dark + Bone	175°F–180°F / 79°C	182°F–185°F / 85°C	Rest 5 min; eliminates bloody/pink joints
Chicken Wings (Flats & Drums)	Dark + Skin	185°F–190°F / 85°C	190°F+ / 88°C	High temp renders subcutaneous wing fat crisp
Whole Roast Chicken (3.5–4 lb)	Mixed Bird	160°F (Breast) / 175°F (Thigh)	165°F / 180°F	Rest 15–20 min before carving so juices settle
Ground Chicken Burgers / Loaf	Minced	162°F / 72°C	165°F / 74°C (Mandatory)	Rest 4 min; ground poultry must reach 165°F

■ USDA TIME-AND-TEMPERATURE PASTEURIZATION TABLE (7-LOG10 SALMONELLA KILL)

Internal Breast Temp (°F / °C)	Hold Time Required at That Temp	Moisture & Texture Result
145°F (62.8°C)	Hold for 9.2 minutes	Sous-vide signature texture; ultra-plump & glossy
150°F (65.6°C)	Hold for 2.8 minutes	Restaurant poach/roast standard; zero dryness
155°F (68.3°C)	Hold for 47 seconds	Ideal resting target for pan-seared chicken breast
160°F (71.1°C)	Hold for 14 seconds	Safe in 14 seconds! Easily achieved during 5-min rest
165°F (73.9°C)	Instant (< 1 second)	Standard USDA instant-kill threshold

■ THERMOMETER PLACEMENT & DONENESS TROUBLESHOOTING

Poultry Scenario	Exact Probe Placement	Why Visual Color Alone Misleads
Whole Roasted Bird	Insert into thickest part of inner thigh without touching bone	Thigh bone marrow often leaches harmless red pigment at 170°F
Pan-Seared / Grilled Breast	Insert horizontally through side into thickest center lobe	Poking from top goes straight through to hot pan (+25°F error)
Smoked / BBQ Chicken	Check both breast (160°F) and leg joint (180°F)	Wood smoke nitric oxide creates a permanent pink 'smoke ring'

CHEF'S PRO TIP: Food safety is a function of BOTH temperature AND time! While 165°F kills Salmonella instantly (<1 second), holding chicken breast at 160°F for just 14 seconds—which happens automatically while resting on a warm plate—achieves the exact same 100% USDA bacterial sterilization while keeping breast meat twice as juicy.
USDA SAFE MINIMUM INTERNAL TEMPS: All Poultry: 165°F (74°C) • Ground Beef/Pork: 160°F (71°C) • Whole Steaks, Chops, Roasts & Fish: 145°F (63°C) + 3-Min Rest

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